



Orville takes
to the air in the
Wright Flyer.



Flying high

The brothers started work on building their own **ENGINE** and created a completely new propeller design with blades based on the shape of a wing. By 1903, their powered glider was ready for a test flight and, on December 17, the **Wright Flyer** took to the air with Orville at the helm. Their first attempt lasted just 12 seconds and they traveled only 120 ft (36.5 m), but they had achieved their **childhood dream**.

The sky's (not) the limit

At the time the Wright brothers made their famous flight, it could take up to three weeks to sail across the Atlantic. Today, the same distance is covered in just a few hours by airplane. The brother's invention brought the world closer together and was the first step in mankind's journey to the Moon and beyond.

They paved the way for...



*Giant passenger aircraft were made possible by the invention of the **JET ENGINE** by English engineer **FRANK WHITTLE** (1907–1996).*

*Just 58 years after Orville's first flight, a Russian called **YURI GAGARIN** (1934–1968) became the first human to fly into **SPACE**.*

